

OE3C Planning Meeting 2

Date: 03 Nov 2025

Location: Online

Time: 10:00–11:33 AM

Attendees: Lyllian Corbin, Alex Wilder, Kiyoko Gotanda, Reem Mahamoud, Rasa Khosrowshahli, Sarah Hein, Nicholas Benton, Matthew Summerville, Lauren Nesbitt, Harry Kumbhani

Minutes by: Lyllian Corbin

Alex began the meeting at 10:00 AM.

Introductions and meeting recap

- Meetings will be in CRN 527 after this week
 - o The room is available weekly on Mondays from 10:00 AM–11:30 AM for meetings and work periods
 - o Meetings will take place bi-weekly after November 3rd
- 50 rooms have been booked at Four Points (\$169 per night)
 - o Hold a minimum of 4 people
 - o There are a mix of bed sizes
- Established subcommittee leads
 - o Subcommittee leads can call their meetings whenever they need to
 - o Keynote speaker lead: Harry Kumbhani
 - Will present top 3 speaker choices at the next meeting
 - Lauren suggested Alison C. (name will be added to the speaker list)
 - o Advertisement lead: Lauren Nesbitt
 - Harry has a list of contacts for biology departments at different universities
 - Logo is the first thing to have ready and branding can be discussed afterwards
 - Alex suggested to keep track of colour hexcodes and fonts for consistency across designs and platforms
 - o **Outings and Socials co-lead: TDB**
 - We could do a social downtown at Margarita's new bar
 - Another option is an outing at Niagara Falls (with passes)
 - Could get a bus to travel as a large group (~\$200)

- Need to figure out logistics of when we are having these excursions
 - (e.g. nighttime, having the first day be the arrival + excursion day, etc.)
- Organisation of files and task progress
 - Trello tool (for tracking conference planning tasks)
 - Files must be stored on Teams
 - All files will be posted under the Files & Documents channel in the appropriate folder

Theme discussion

- Current theme: “Coexisting with nature”
 - We need to come to a consensus on the finalised verbiage/phrase
 - Alex will put out a vote for the theme to be announced at the next meeting
- Notes on the theme discussion:
 - Alex liked the “living in nature” suggestion Nick made last week
 - Lauren suggested something catchier, perhaps “coevolving”
 - Matt is still thinking about the verbiage but agrees with using the term “harmony”
 - Nick suggested a theme that implies being productive with nature, perhaps people “working with nature”
 - Kiyoko suggested avoiding use of “evolution” in the theme
 - Need to keep the main theme broad
 - We can have subthemes that tie into the keynote speakers
 - Spoke to Justin yesterday
 - It is worth hiring conference services (will cost \$500)
 - They can help with registration and putting out fires during the conference
 - They are mainly there for support and can provide services on our request
 - Kiyoko will email conference services for more information on what services they provide
 - Good areas for poster sessions
 - Market Square – has plenty of space
 - We could also use both floors of Pond Inlet

Logo discussion with Lauren

- Lauren can get shirts printed through her dad’s work
 - Needs to figure out costs
- First logo idea: Niagara Falls in the background with grapes in the foreground

- Second idea: a Trillium flower with windmill blades as the petals and incorporating an animal on the logo (like a badger to represent Brock)
 - Alex likes this idea but realised during the meeting that Carlton used the Trillium in their design for last year's OE3C logo
- Harry suggested to base the logo on the theme of the conference
 - For example, the OE3C 2024 Scream logo tied to Waterloo's theme of "dismantling biophobia"
 - Used animals that people are typically weary of (snakes, bats, spiders) with the Scream painting
- Lyly suggested using the Niagara Escarpment in the background of the logo
- Rasa agreed with the escarpment idea and suggested showing animals related to Charles Darwin's research (e.g. finches)

Workshop discussion with Nicholas

- Nick suggested we could host a tour around the Escarpment to show off the biodiversity of the area
 - We could bring in specimens to show people all the taxa in the area
 - Harry mentioned that the 2024 OE3C Waterloo team did bird banding, toured conservation sites, hosted a viewing of taxidermy animals, and hosted tree planting
 - Alex explained that we do not have anyone that is specialised in bird banding, but we do have specimens we can show from the zoology lab
 - Harry and Alex can contact people (from Waterloo and Windsor) to bring in more taxidermy animals
- Lauren suggested hosting a guided tour with someone to show different tree species
 - Matt might be a good contact for this idea
 - We could also contact Niagara jet boat tours or Canadian "maid of the mist"
 - Sarah mentioned it might be too cold for this idea because the conference is happening in early May
 - Alex mentioned offering discounted slots and conference attendees can have the option to choose these tours if they want to
- Sarah suggested hosting a tree coring workshop
 - Their lab has permits to core trees and can demonstrate the process to conference attendees
- Alex suggested making sure we have a workshop that covers all three E's to make the conference more interdisciplinary

Brief discussion on registration with Reem

- Reem will eventually meet with Brock's Conference Services (along with Kiyoko, Alex, and Lillian) to discuss the logistics for organising registration

Keynote speakers discussion – we will circle back to this for the next meeting

Fundraising discussion with Alex

- Alex will meet with Sarah and Harry to go over budget information
 - o Harry will bring up any relevant information from 2024 OE3C's budget/expenses
 - We might have a record of budget history from 2023 to 2025
- Alex will send out the fundraising package which contains sponsorship tiers and details to show the impact of the conference
 - o Harry confirmed that OE3C 2024 had 35 posters and 53 talks
 - o Reem will talk to Dr. Mangal about sending the fundraising package to Destiny Copper
 - o A separate fundraising package will be created to send to smaller businesses
 - People with connections to certain companies/businesses will be the preferred contact for that company

Undergraduate representatives and volunteer discussion with Alex

- Alex will create a general call for volunteers to sign up
 - o The sign-up list will be given to the subcommittee leads so they can personally reach out to volunteers
- Reem and Lauren will help score applications to select the OE3C undergraduate representatives

Banquet discussion with Alex

- The team is in favour of hosting a banquet
- Lauren asked about holding the awards ceremony during the banquet
 - o Alex liked this idea and explained that Melanie Pilkington suggested to make the audience judge presentations
 - They tried this idea GRAMSS' FMS GRaD 2025 conference but the Microsoft form didn't work for some people, so we will have to use a different platform for OE3C guests to submit their feedback on

- presentations (and not all guests will have a Brock account so they will not be able to use the Microsoft form)
 - Alex will ask Melanie to come to a future meeting to go over this idea more
- We agreed to hold the banquet in the Pond Inlet at the end of the conference and have the awards presented there
 - Alex wants to invite Peter Berg, Melanie Pilkington, and Leslie Riggs for the ceremony
 - Leslie needs to be contact ASAP
 - We will sell tickets for the banquet

Questions/General discussion

- OE3C Bluesky account is in the process of being made
- Rasa has access to the OE3C website
 - Justin should have a marketing package that will be helpful for using Brock's branding
- Matt has access to the OE3C social accounts
- Sarah asked what numbers we are aiming for attendance-wise
 - Alex stated their goal is to have 200-250 people and 80 talks
 - Harry confirmed that Waterloo had 150 people and 88 talks
- Alex briefly discussed abstracts and presentations
 - We will hold lightning talks and proposal talks to have a broader range of presentations (for proposed/ongoing/completed research from undergraduates and graduates)
 - Sarah Hein will be co-leading the abstract review
- Next meeting (Nov 17th, 2025)
 - We will go over the completed/in-progress actions and next steps for each subcommittee

Meeting adjourned at 11:33 AM.